The photographs that *finish the website.*

The website is designed and built. Every page works today, on phones and computers. What it is missing is real photography: 19 spots currently hold a placeholder. This guide shows each one exactly where it sits on the website and describes the photograph that replaces it.

See the live website: chef-ray-gennaro.vercel.app

Where the website stands

Design & build — Complete

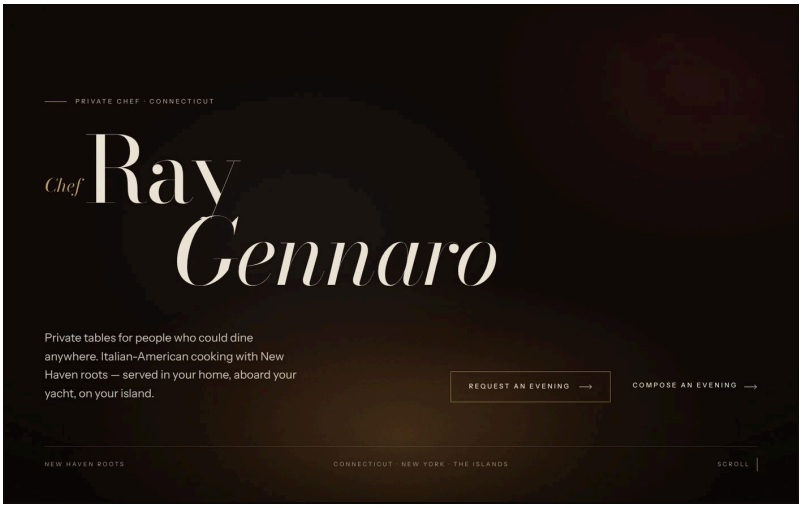
- ✓ Home page
- ✓ The Chef, with his story
- ✓ Private invitations
- ✓ Experiences
- ✓ Request an evening
- ✓ Phone and computer layouts

Photography — 0 of 19

ESSENTIAL 7 photos needed before launch

IMPORTANT 5 strongly recommended

COMPLETES THE SET 7 can follow after launch



The home page today on a computer



On a phone

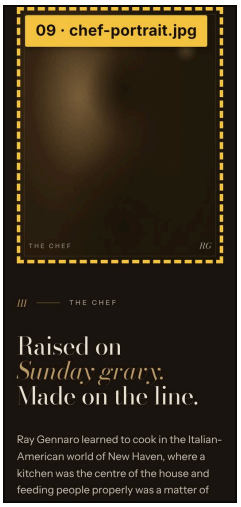


Photo 09, on a phone

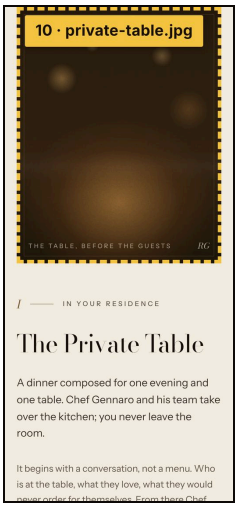


Photo 10, on a phone

The placeholders are not empty boxes on purpose: each one is a sketch of the light and color the real photograph should have. Use them as a guide to mood. The photograph replaces them exactly, at the same size and shape.

For every photograph

Real light only. Candles, windows, lamps, sunset. No flash, no bright overhead light.	**Warm and dark.** Deep brown shadows, amber candlelight, ivory linen, aged brass. Like a still from a film.
Shallow focus. Fast lens, f/1.4–2.8. Background lights melt into soft circles.	**No guest faces.** Hands, shoulders, backs and silhouettes only. Discretion is part of the brand.
Chef Ray is always real. Any photo of him, his family or his past must be a real photograph. Never a stand-in or an imitation.	**Nothing branded.** No logos, wine labels, boat names or recognizable homes.
Leave room at the edges. The website trims about 5% from each edge and adds a caption along the bottom.	**One look throughout.** Edit all photos with the same warm, slightly muted grade.

Delivery

Format	JPEG, sRGB, highest quality. Keep the RAW files.
Portrait (4:5)	At least 2400 × 3000 px. Photos 09–19.
Landscape (16:11)	At least 2400 × 1650 px. Photos 01–08.
File names	Exactly as written on each card, lower case.
Alternates	Two or three strong variations of each, named `-alt1`, `-alt2`.

Shoot these first

These seven make the website ready to launch. Four of them need Chef Ray in person.

- 01 A home in Connecticut
- 09 Chef Ray in his kitchen
- 10 I. The Private Table
- 11 II. The Island & The Water
- 12 III. The Kitchen Lessons
- 13 IV. The Occasion
- 19 VI. Wherever the table is

SUGGESTED SESSIONS

With Chef Ray

Half day in a kitchen with good window light

09 12 18 19

The dining room

One evening in a Connecticut home

01 10 13 16

Water and travel

Dusk shoots by the water; some can wait for a trip

05 06 11 17 04 08

Special locations

Scheduled as access allows

02 03 07 15

From the family archive

Scanning, no photographer needed

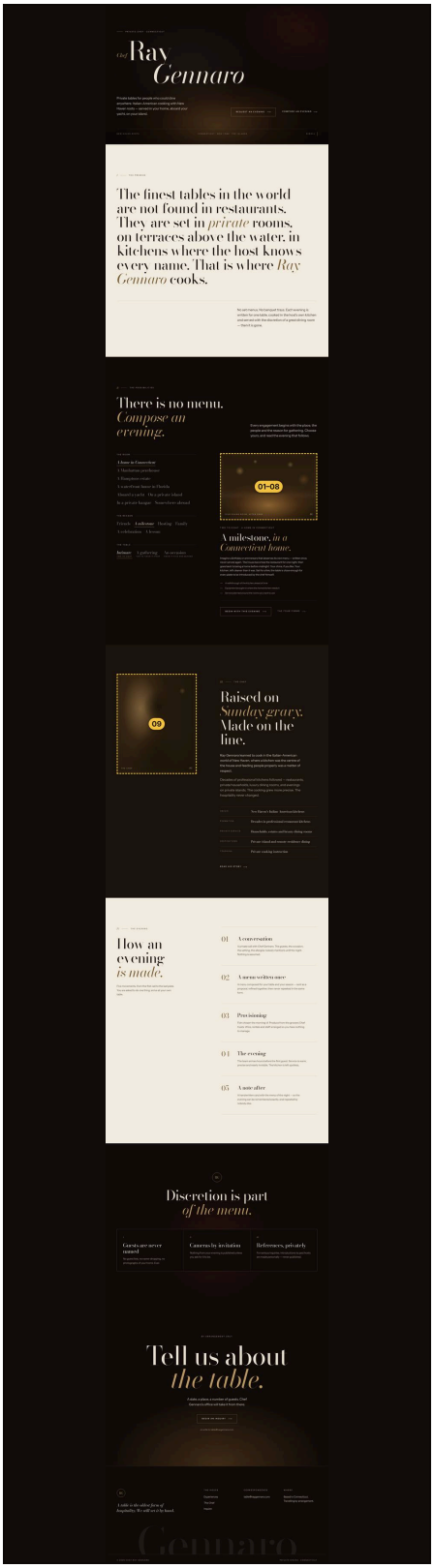
14

PAGE · CHEF-RAY-GENNARO.VERCEL.APP

Home

Two places on the home page need photographs: the room shown in “Compose an evening” (it changes as visitors choose, so there are eight), and the portrait introducing Chef Ray.

Photographs 01–09 · 9 shots



The whole page, top to bottom. Numbers mark each photo.

01

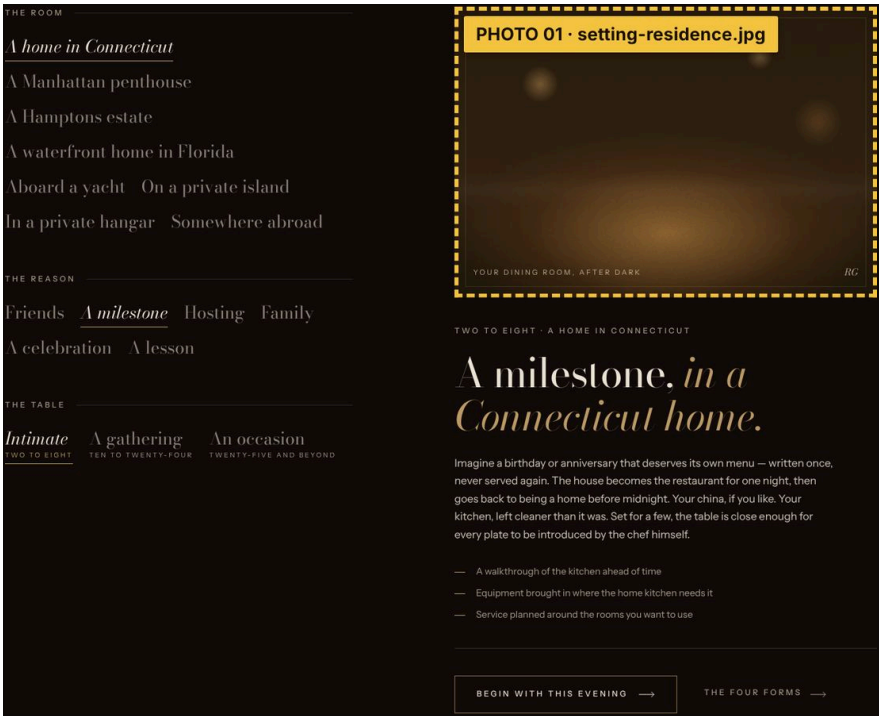
ESSENTIAL

Caption on site: “Your dining room, after dark”

☐ Captured

A home in Connecticut

`setting-residence.jpg`



On the website today. The yellow outline is the placeholder this photograph replaces.

The first room a visitor sees in “Compose an evening”. It is the default view, so it shows up on the home page before anyone clicks.

WHAT TO CAPTURE

A real Connecticut dining room at night, set for a private dinner, photographed from the doorway at standing height. It should feel like a home, not a hotel.

IN THE FRAME

- Polished wood table for about eight, dressed in ivory linen.
- Lit candles in aged-brass holders down the middle; wine already poured.
- Classic New England room: painted wood paneling, a dark window, a brass chandelier dimmed low.
- Through an open door on the right: a slice of warm kitchen light with a figure working at the stove, out of focus.
- Lived-in details in shadow: books on a sideboard, a framed painting.

LIGHT & COLOR

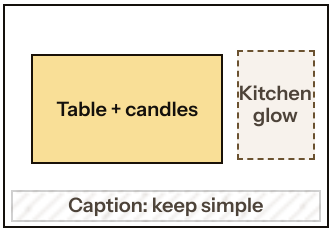
Candles and the dimmed chandelier only. Warm amber on the table, deep brown shadow in the corners.

AVOID

Bright overhead light, flash, guests' faces, anything that identifies the homeowner.

WHAT'S NEEDED

A real dining room in Connecticut; table linen, candles, glassware. Chef Ray optional (as the blurred figure in the kitchen).



Framing guide · 16:11 landscape · 2400 × 1650 px or larger

02

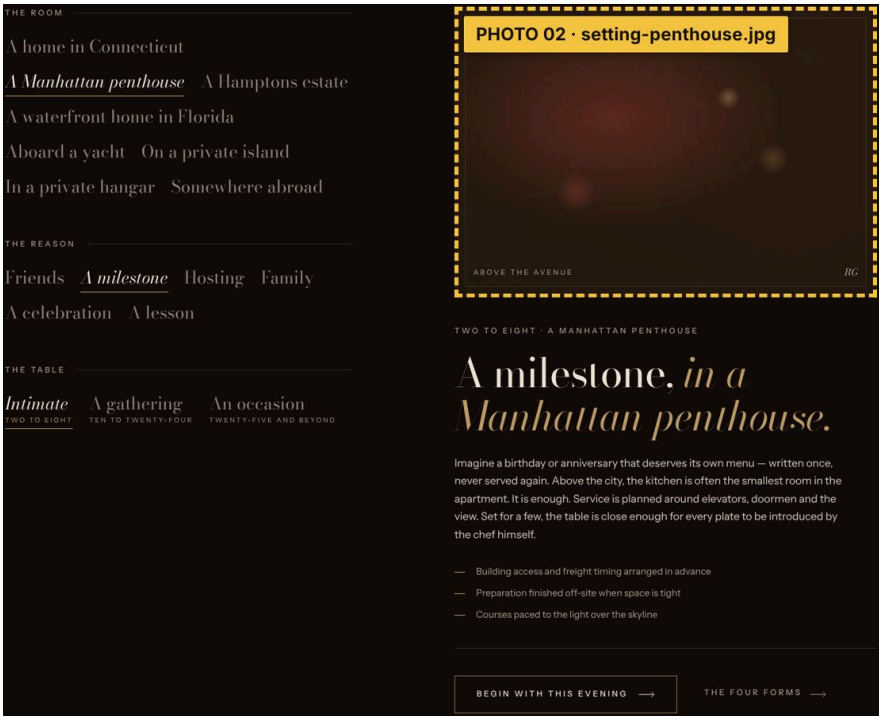
IMPORTANT

Caption on site: “Above the avenue”

☐ Captured

A Manhattan penthouse

`setting-penthouse.jpg`



On the website today. The yellow outline is the placeholder this photograph replaces.

Shown when a visitor picks “A Manhattan penthouse”.

WHAT TO CAPTURE

A dinner table for six in front of floor-to-ceiling windows in a high-floor New York apartment at night, with the city glowing out of focus beyond the glass.

IN THE FRAME

- Table in the lower half of the frame: ivory linen, low candles, crystal glasses.
- City lights through the window fill the upper half: thousands of soft points of light.
- Minimal, expensive interior: dark wood floor, one sculptural lamp, an artwork in shadow.

LIGHT & COLOR

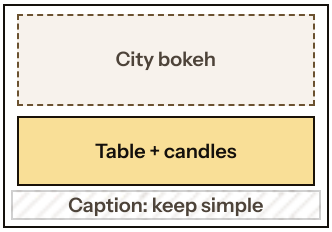
Candlelight on the table, cool city glow on the glass. Warm inside, cool outside.

AVOID

Recognizable landmarks or skyline, reflections of the photographer in the glass, guests' faces.

WHAT'S NEEDED

A high-floor apartment with big windows (a rental or client's home with permission).



Framing guide · 16:11 landscape · 2400 × 1650 px or larger

03

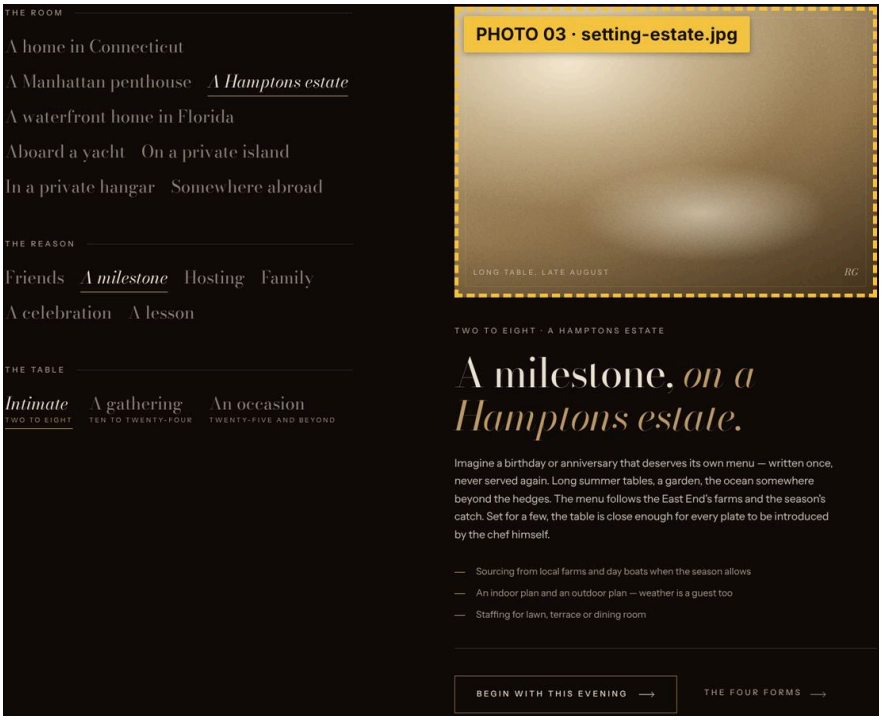
COMPLETES THE SET

Caption on site: “Long table, late August”

☐ Captured

A Hamptons estate

`setting-estate.jpg`



On the website today. The yellow outline is the placeholder this photograph replaces.

Shown when a visitor picks “A Hamptons estate”.

WHAT TO CAPTURE

A long outdoor table for twenty on the lawn of a shingled summer estate, about 20 minutes before sunset, shot from one end so the table runs diagonally into the frame.

IN THE FRAME

- Natural linen, low garden flowers and herbs, glass hurricane lanterns.
- Tall privet hedges and a shingled house with white trim softly in the background.
- Optional: two distant staff silhouettes carrying platters.

LIGHT & COLOR

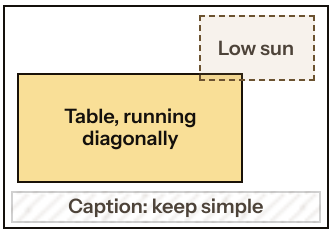
Low golden sun from behind the table so glasses glow and edges catch gold. Sky warm gold fading to peach.

AVOID

Harsh midday sun, recognizable houses, guests' faces.

WHAT'S NEEDED

A large lawn or garden; a long table setup. Golden hour only.



Framing guide · 16:11 landscape · 2400 × 1650 px or larger

04

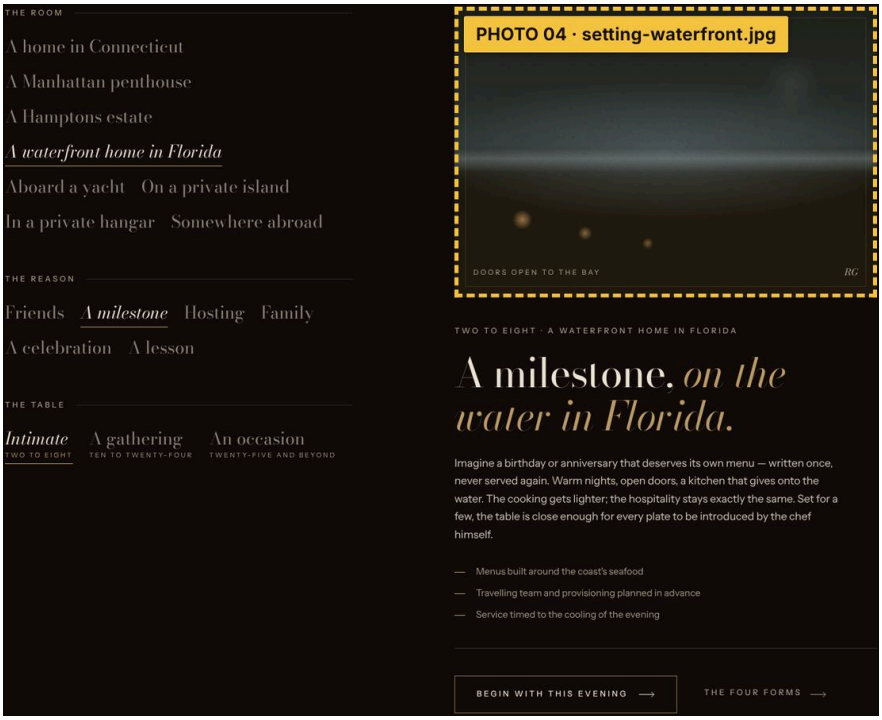
COMPLETES THE SET

Caption on site: “Doors open to the bay”

☐ Captured

A waterfront home in Florida

`setting-waterfront.jpg`



On the website today. The yellow outline is the placeholder this photograph replaces.

Shown when a visitor picks “A waterfront home in Florida”.

WHAT TO CAPTURE

Looking out from inside a waterfront home at blue hour: tall glass doors folded open, a table set on the terrace, calm water beyond.

IN THE FRAME

- Pale stone floor, white curtains moving slightly.
- Terrace table for eight: white linen, low candles, bowls of citrus, a whole roasted fish on a platter.
- Calm bay in deep indigo, palm fronds in silhouette at the edges, a few warm dock lights.

LIGHT & COLOR

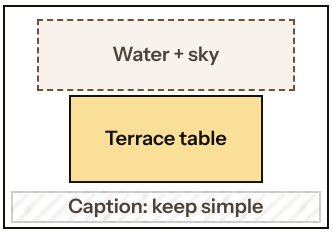
Blue hour (just after sunset): indigo sky and water, warm candles on the table.

AVOID

Bright daytime sun, visible neighbors' houses, guests' faces.

WHAT'S NEEDED

A waterfront home (Florida or any warm coast).



Framing guide · 16:11 landscape · 2400 × 1650 px or larger

05

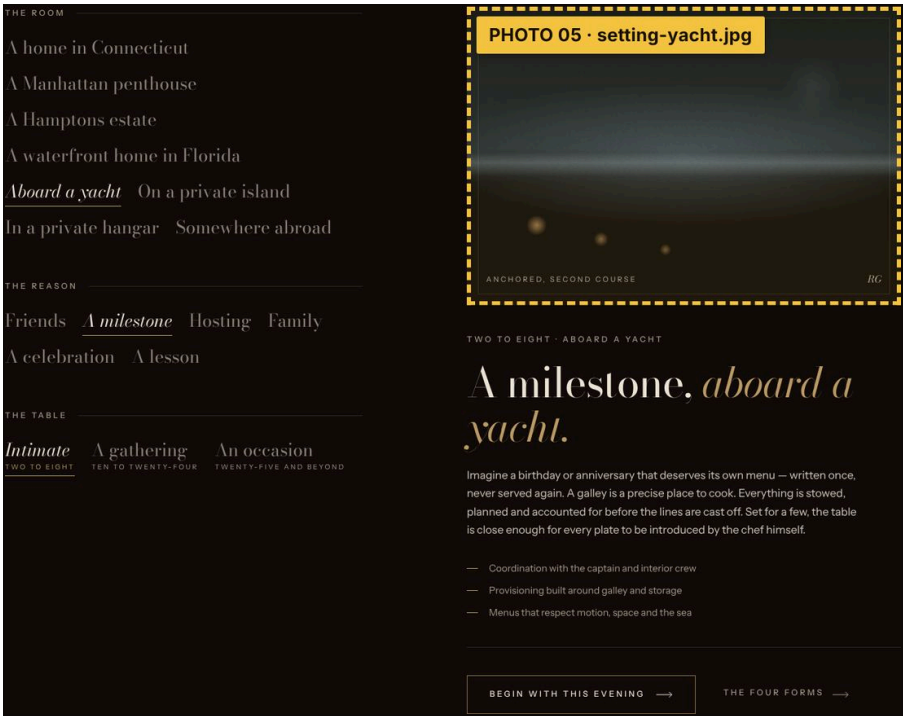
IMPORTANT

Caption on site: “Anchored, second course”

☐ Captured

Aboard a yacht

`setting-yacht.jpg`



On the website today. The yellow outline is the placeholder this photograph replaces.

Shown when a visitor picks “Aboard a yacht”.

WHAT TO CAPTURE

The back deck of a large yacht at anchor just after sunset, table set for ten, open water filling the background. Shot at seated height so the table edge is the foreground.

IN THE FRAME

- Teak table, ivory linen, candles in glass (they stay lit in the breeze), crystal stemware.
- Polished rail and a coiled rope for a sense of place.
- Horizon of fading orange and deep blue; a far-off coastline with a few lights.
- Optional: a crew member's white-sleeved hand placing a plate.

LIGHT & COLOR

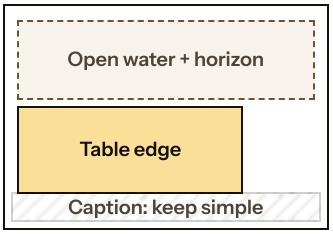
Last light of sunset plus candles.

AVOID

Boat name, flags, registration numbers, guests' faces.

WHAT'S NEEDED

A yacht (charter or client, with permission). Calm evening.



Framing guide · 16:11 landscape · 2400 × 1650 px or larger

06

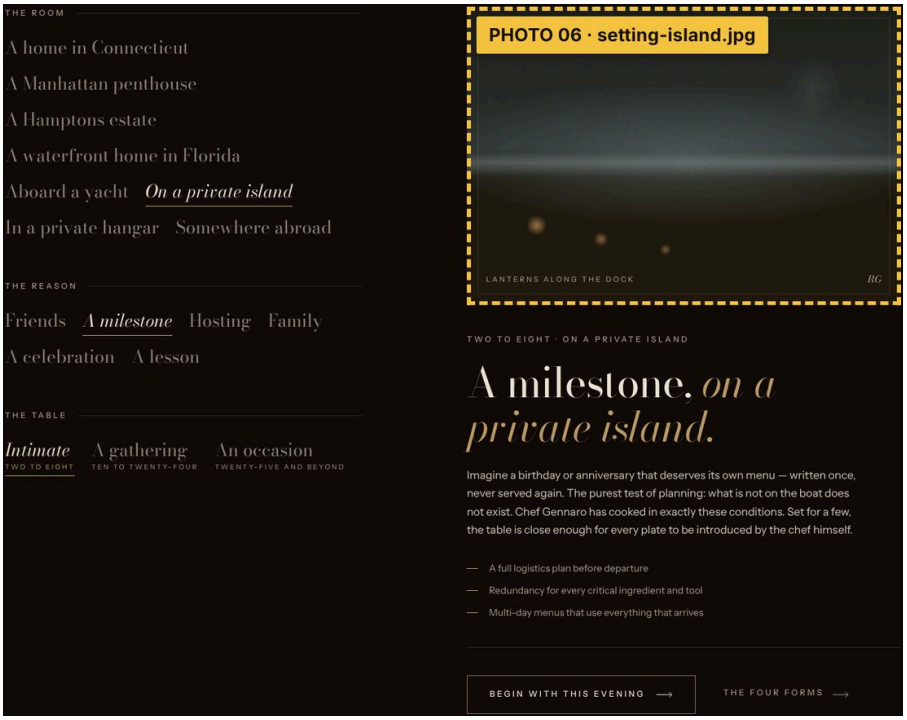
IMPORTANT

Caption on site: “Lanterns along the dock”

☐ Captured

On a private island

`setting-island.jpg`



On the website today. The yellow outline is the placeholder this photograph replaces.

Shown when a visitor picks “On a private island”. This is one of Chef Ray's signature stories.

WHAT TO CAPTURE

From the end of a long wooden dock at dusk, looking back toward the shore: lanterns line both sides of the dock and lead the eye to a single lit table under a simple canopy.

IN THE FRAME

- Weathered silver-grey planks, glowing lanterns on both sides.
- At the far end: a table for six under an open canopy among tropical trees.
- Clear dark water reflecting the lantern light in long streaks.
- No other buildings or boats in sight.

LIGHT & COLOR

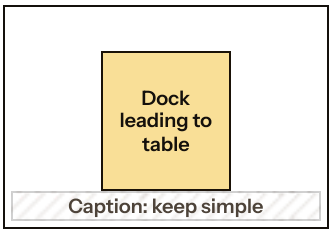
Dusk: violet sky with a thin orange horizon, warm lanterns.

AVOID

Resort signage, other guests, anything that identifies the island or client.

WHAT'S NEEDED

Ideally a real photo from one of Chef Ray's island engagements (client details removed). Otherwise a private dock at dusk.



Framing guide · 16:11 landscape · 2400 × 1650 px or larger

07

COMPLETES THE SET

Caption on site: “Wheels down, table set”

☐ Captured

In a private hangar

`setting-hangar.jpg`



On the website today. The yellow outline is the placeholder this photograph replaces.

Shown when a visitor picks “In a private hangar”.

WHAT TO CAPTURE

Inside a spotless private-jet hangar at night, turned into a dining room: a long candlelit table with the nose and wing of a white jet softly out of focus behind it.

IN THE FRAME

- Long table for sixteen, ivory linen, tall candelabras.
- Warm uplights and hanging bulbs against the vast dark ceiling.
- Glossy floor faintly reflecting the candles.

LIGHT & COLOR

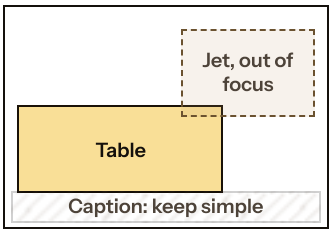
Warm table light against a cool, dark, cavernous space.

AVOID

Airline logos, tail numbers, guests' faces.

WHAT'S NEEDED

Access to a private aviation hangar or FBO. Can be scheduled later.

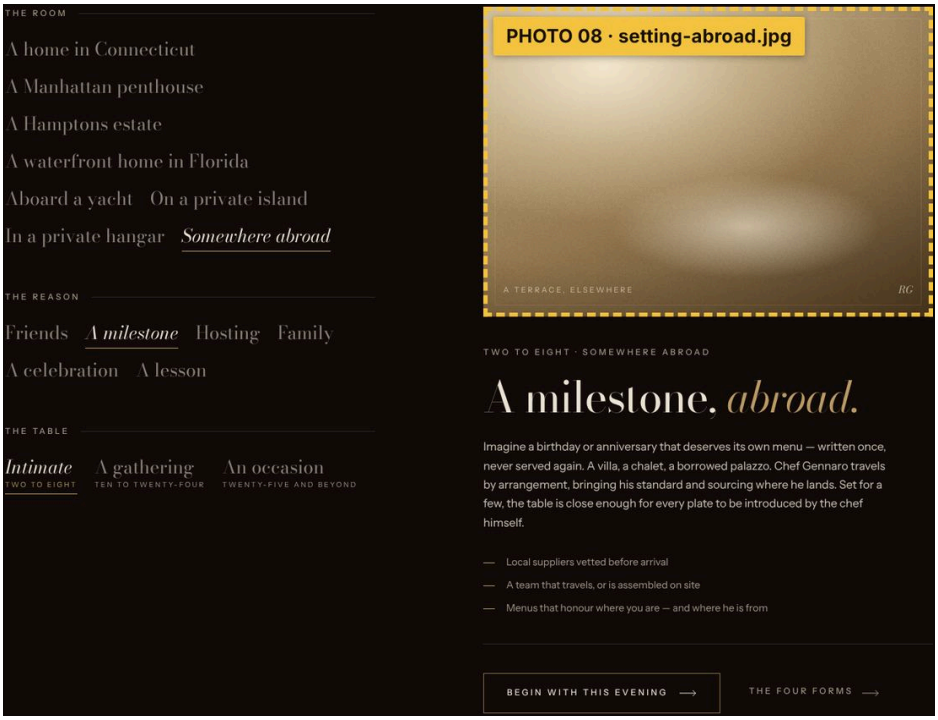


Framing guide · 16:11 landscape · 2400 × 1650 px or larger

08 COMPLETES THE SET Caption on site: “A terrace, elsewhere” ☐ Captured

Somewhere abroad

`setting-abroad.jpg`



On the website today. The yellow outline is the placeholder this photograph replaces.

Shown when a visitor picks “Somewhere abroad”. It connects quietly to his Italian roots.

WHAT TO CAPTURE

A stone terrace of a villa in Italy or on a Mediterranean lake at the end of a summer day, table set for eight, hills or water in soft haze beyond.

IN THE FRAME

- Weathered stone balustrade, pots of lemon trees, vines on a pergola overhead.
- Rustic white linen, carafes of wine, bowls of figs and lemons, low candles.
- Distant hills or lake in blue-gold haze.

LIGHT & COLOR

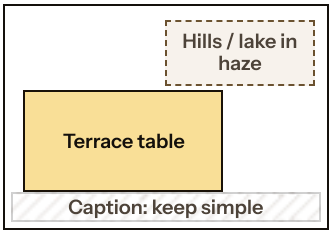
Warm late sun from the side, long shadows across stone.

AVOID

Famous landmarks, hotel branding, guests' faces.

WHAT'S NEEDED

Can come from a future trip; a European terrace at sunset.



Framing guide · 16:11 landscape · 2400 × 1650 px or larger

09

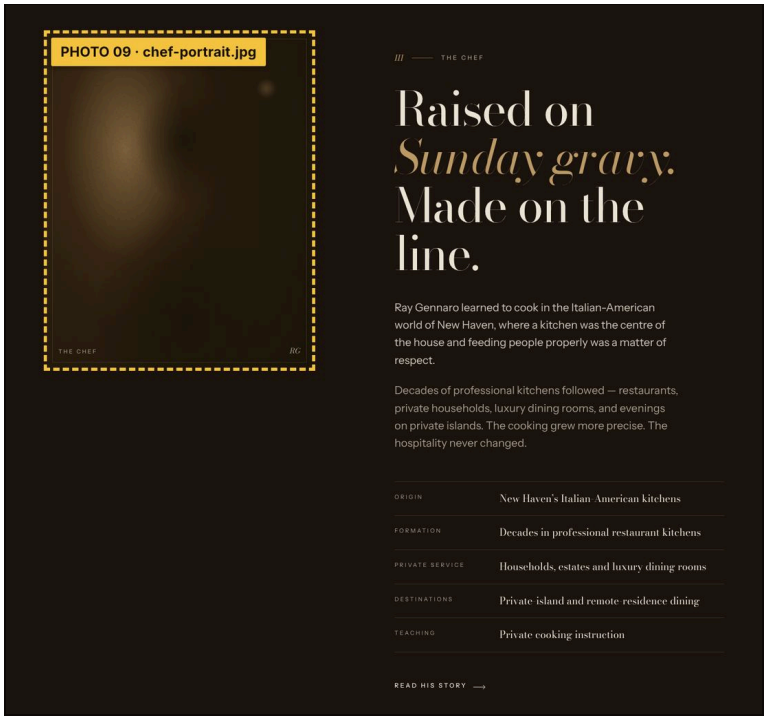
ESSENTIAL

Caption on site: “The Chef”

☐ Captured

Chef Ray in his kitchen

`chef-portrait.jpg`



On the website today. The yellow outline is the placeholder this photograph replaces.

The most important photograph on the website. It introduces Chef Ray on the home page next to “Raised on Sunday gravy. Made on the line.”

WHAT TO CAPTURE

A real, natural portrait of Chef Ray standing in a kitchen, framed from mid-thigh up, one hand resting on a worn wooden counter. He looks just past the lens, as if listening to someone: confident, warm, unposed.

IN THE FRAME

- Wardrobe: charcoal or black chef's jacket with sleeves pushed up, or a dark tailored shirt with a long dark apron. A towel tucked at the hip.
- Background softly out of focus: hanging copper pots, a shelf of glass jars, the blue-orange glow of a burner.
- His body turned slightly to camera right, face toward the window light.

LIGHT & COLOR

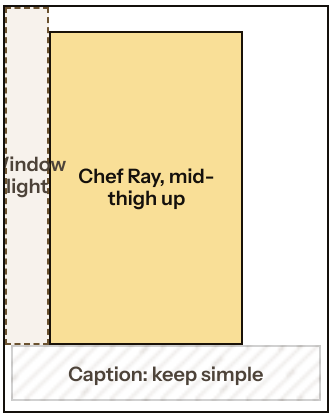
One soft window light from camera left lighting one side of his face. The right side of the frame falls into warm shadow.

AVOID

Studio backdrop, flash, big smile at camera, arms crossed, heavy retouching.

WHAT'S NEEDED

Chef Ray. A kitchen with a window and some character (his own kitchen is ideal).



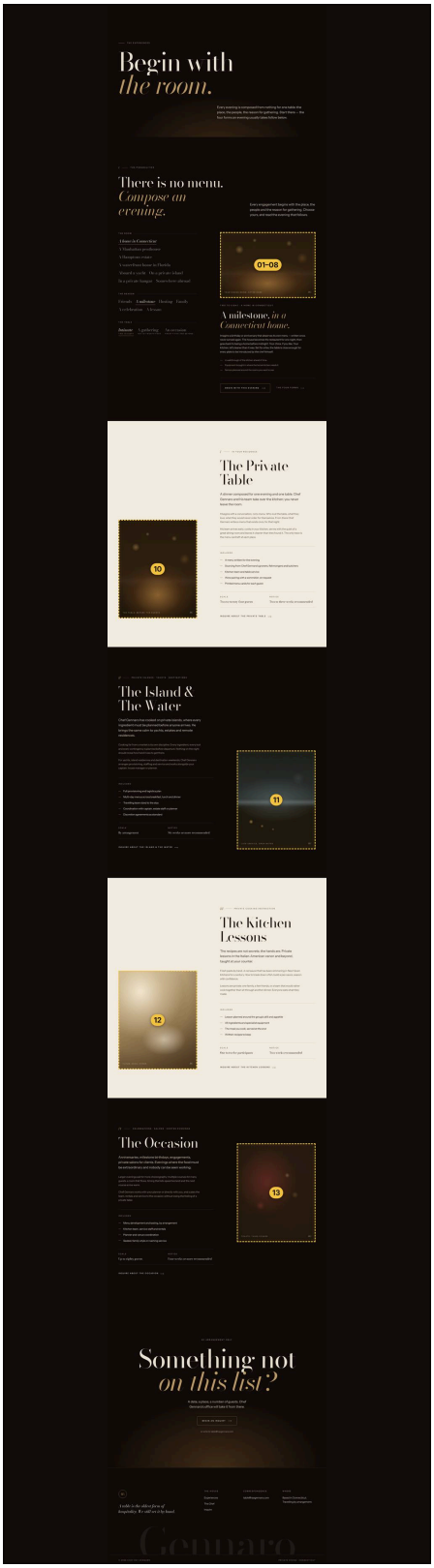
Framing guide · 4:5 portrait · 2400 × 3000 px or larger

PAGE · CHEF-RAY-GENNARO.VERCEL.APP/EXPERIENCES

Experiences

The Experiences page repeats “Compose an evening” (Photos 01–08, no extra shots needed) and then needs one photograph for each of the four ways to book Chef Ray.

Photographs 10–13 · 4 shots



The whole page, top to bottom. Numbers mark each photo.

10

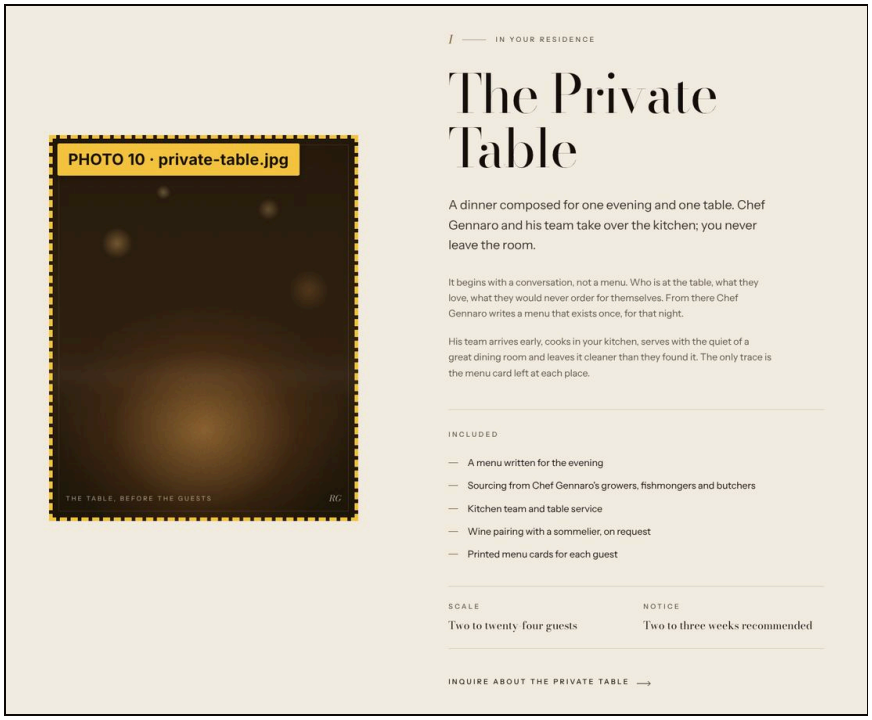
ESSENTIAL

Caption on site: “The table, before the guests”

☐ Captured

I. The Private Table

`private-table.jpg`



On the website today. The yellow outline is the placeholder this photograph replaces.

Beside “The Private Table”, his core private-dinner service.

WHAT TO CAPTURE

A candlelit dinner table in a private home, photographed from a seated guest's eye level looking across the table. The minute before guests sit down.

IN THE FRAME

- Foreground: table edge in ivory linen, white plate with a fine brass rim, folded napkin with a printed menu card tucked in, heavy silver cutlery.
- Middle: three lit candles in aged-brass holders, crystal glasses with red wine.
- Background: two empty upholstered chairs across the table, waiting, in warm darkness.

LIGHT & COLOR

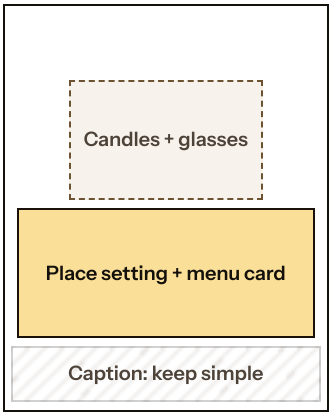
Candles only.

AVOID

People, bright room lights, logos on bottles.

WHAT'S NEEDED

Same dining room as Photo 01 works well. Menu card prop.



Framing guide · 4:5 portrait · 2400 × 3000 px or larger

11

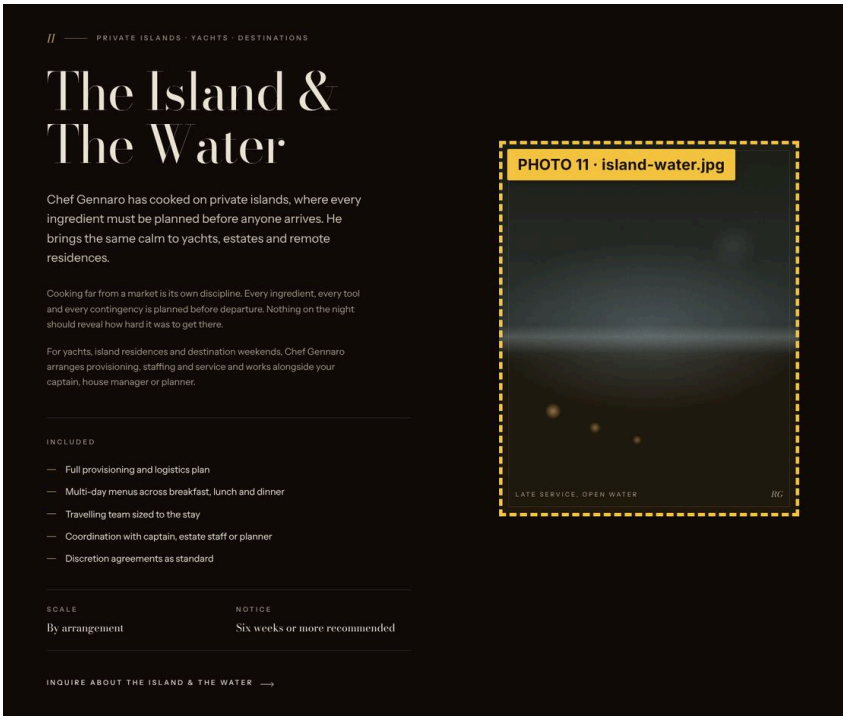
ESSENTIAL

Caption on site: “Late service, open water”

☐ Captured

II. The Island & The Water

`island-water.jpg`



On the website today. The yellow outline is the placeholder this photograph replaces.

Beside “The Island & The Water”: yachts, islands and destinations.

WHAT TO CAPTURE

A dinner table on a stone terrace above open water at the very end of dusk, shot from behind and slightly above one chair.

IN THE FRAME

- Table for four: ivory linen held by brass weights, candles in glass hurricanes, a platter of grilled whole fish with lemons and herbs.
- Beyond the balustrade: dark open sea; horizon a thin cold blue-grey band with a trace of orange; one distant light of an anchored boat.
- Top of the frame: night sky.

LIGHT & COLOR

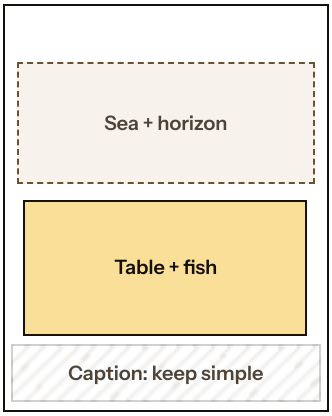
Candlelight against the cool last light over the water.

AVOID

Other buildings, beach crowds, guests' faces.

WHAT'S NEEDED

A waterside terrace (coast, lake or island). Shoot at dusk.



Framing guide · 4:5 portrait · 2400 × 3000 px or larger

12

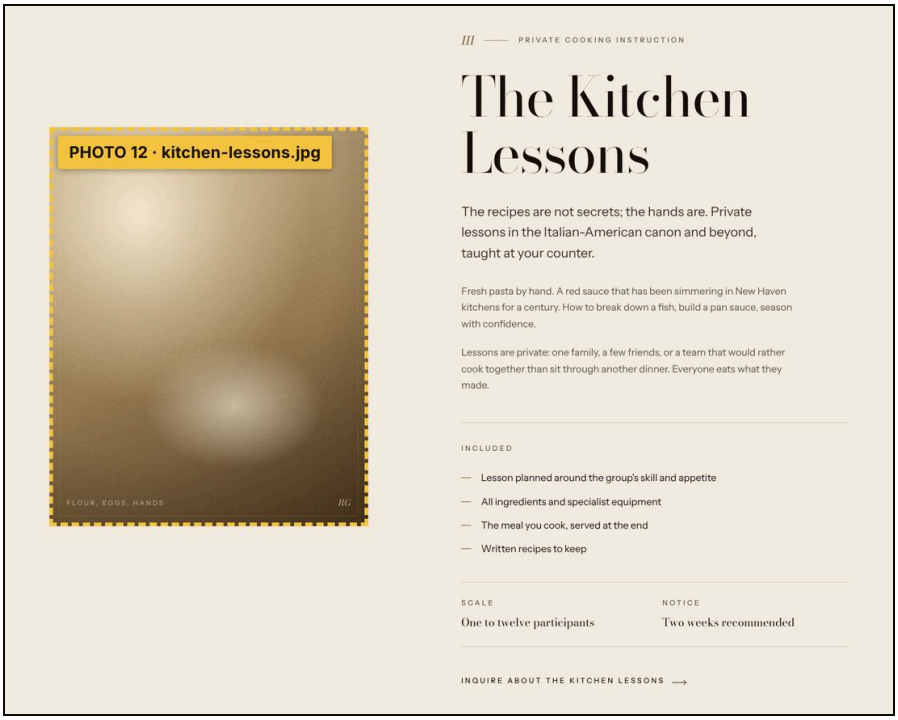
ESSENTIAL

Caption on site: “Flour, eggs, hands”

☐ Captured

III. The Kitchen Lessons

`kitchen-lessons.jpg`



On the website today. The yellow outline is the placeholder this photograph replaces.

Beside “The Kitchen Lessons”, his private cooking classes.

WHAT TO CAPTURE

Close on two pairs of hands at a floured wooden counter: Chef Ray's hands guiding a guest's hands as they fold eggs into a well of flour to make pasta dough.

IN THE FRAME

- Chef Ray: rolled sleeves, dark apron just visible. Guest: cream knit sleeve.
- Around them: wooden rolling pin, bench scraper, a bowl of brown eggs, a mound of finished dough under a cloth.
- Flour dust floating in a shaft of window light.

LIGHT & COLOR

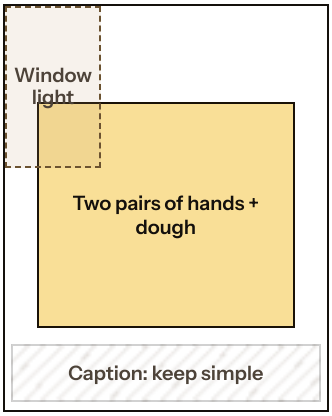
Soft daylight from a window on the left. Brighter and warmer than the evening photos.

AVOID

Faces, messy counters, plastic or branded tools.

WHAT'S NEEDED

Chef Ray plus one person as the 'guest' (hands only). Flour, eggs, a wooden board.



Framing guide · 4:5 portrait · 2400 × 3000 px or larger

13

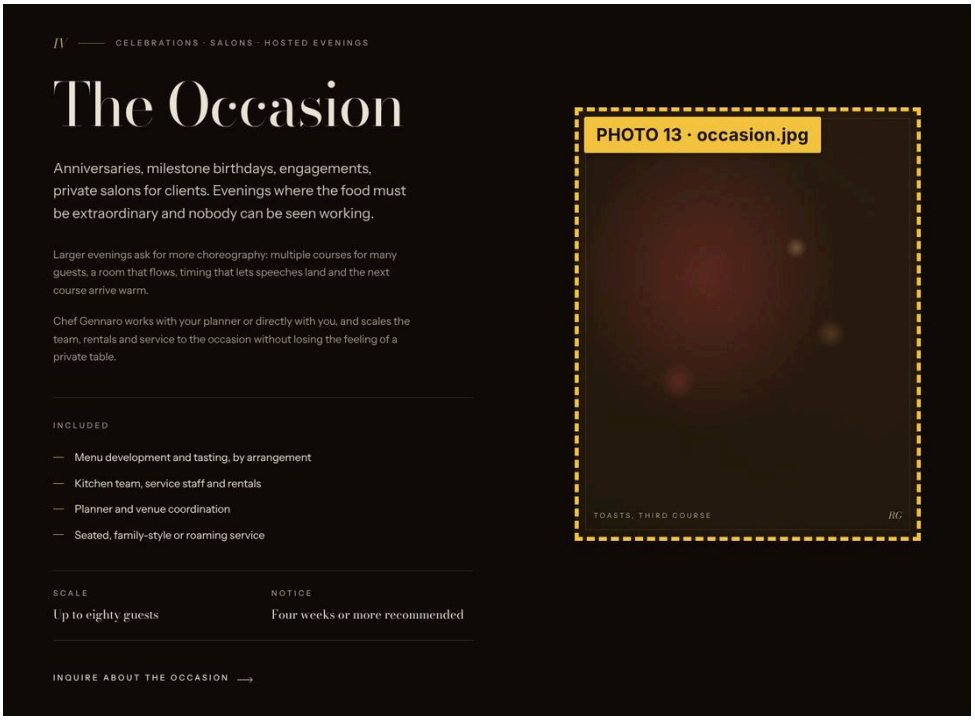
ESSENTIAL

Caption on site: “Toasts, third course”

☐ Captured

IV. The Occasion

`occasion.jpg`



On the website today. The yellow outline is the placeholder this photograph replaces.

Beside “The Occasion”: celebrations and hosted events.

WHAT TO CAPTURE

The moment of a toast at a long celebration table in low warm light. A dozen hands raise glasses above the table; nobody's face is shown.

IN THE FRAME

- Hands, sleeves and shoulders only: dark jackets, a silk dress strap, a bracelet catching light.
- Slight motion blur on the raised glasses.
- Table: candles, half-finished plates, loose garden roses in burgundy and ivory.
- Background: a warm, softly lit room with an arched window.

LIGHT & COLOR

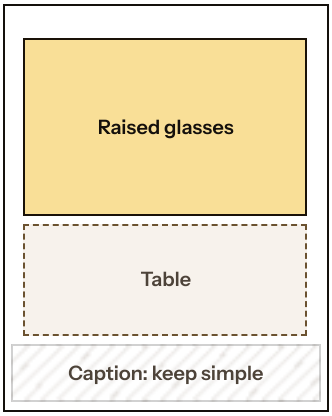
Low, warm, candlelit. A little haze is welcome.

AVOID

Recognizable faces, phones, branded bottles.

WHAT'S NEEDED

8–12 people as guests (faces turned away or out of frame). Can be staged with friends.



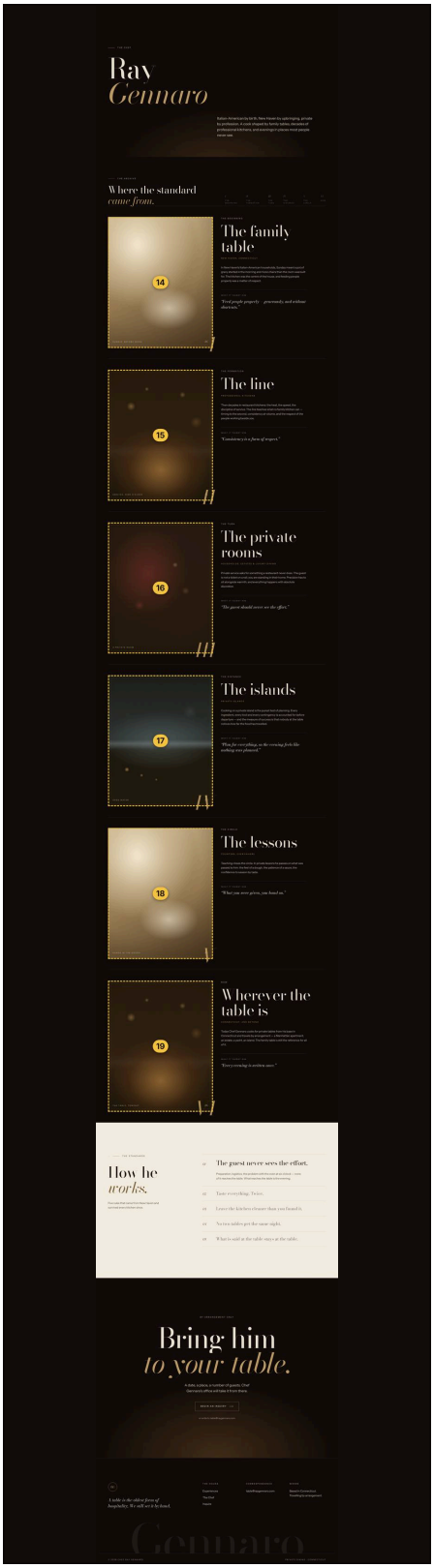
Framing guide · 4:5 portrait · 2400 × 3000 px or larger

PAGE · CHEF-RAY-GENNARO.VERCEL.APP/CHEF

The Chef

Chef Ray's story is told in six eras called The Archive. Each era needs one photograph. Where real photos from his past exist, they are better than anything new.

Photographs 14–19 · 6 shots



The whole page, top to bottom. Numbers mark each photo.

14

COMPLETES THE SET

Caption on site: “Sunday, before noon”

☐ Captured

I. The family table

`01-family-table.jpg`



On the website today. The yellow outline is the placeholder this photograph replaces.

The first era of his story, New Haven. Real history: this should be a real family photograph if one exists.

WHAT TO CAPTURE

First choice: a real photo from Chef Ray's childhood or youth in New Haven (a crowded Sunday table, a grandparent at the stove), scanned in high resolution. If none exists, shoot a present-day still life instead, never an imitation of an old photo.

IN THE FRAME

- Still-life option: a heavy enamel pot of red sauce simmering on an old white stove, a long wooden spoon across the top, steam rising.
- Around it: crusty Italian bread on a cloth, a jar of dried oregano, a handwritten recipe card, a glass of red wine.

LIGHT & COLOR

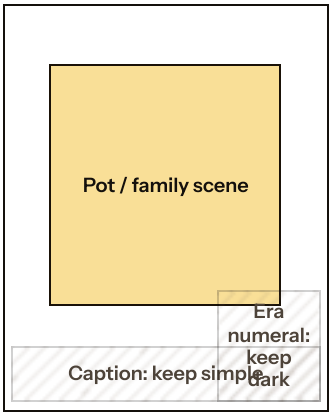
Soft morning window light. Cream, tomato red, warm wood.

AVOID

Fake 'vintage' filters on new photos.

WHAT'S NEEDED

Family photo albums (scan at 1200 dpi) or the still-life props.

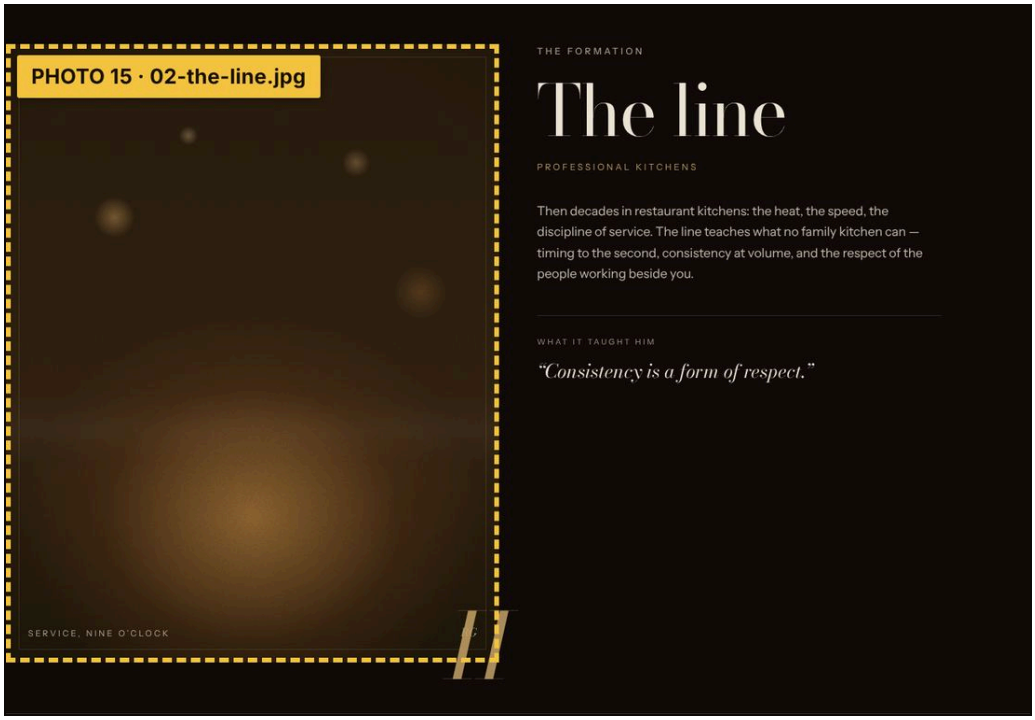


Framing guide · 4:5 portrait · 2400 × 3000 px or larger

15 IMPORTANT Caption on site: “Service, nine o'clock” ☐ Captured

II. The line

`02-the-line.jpg`



On the website today. The yellow outline is the placeholder this photograph replaces.

Era II of his story: decades in restaurant kitchens.

WHAT TO CAPTURE

First choice: a real photo of Chef Ray on a restaurant line. Otherwise: a professional kitchen mid-service, shot from the end of the line at hip height, with flame in the foreground pan.

IN THE FRAME

- Stainless steel, a row of burners with tall flames under steel pans, steam.
- Order tickets hanging on a rail above.
- A cook in whites with his back to camera, out of focus.

LIGHT & COLOR

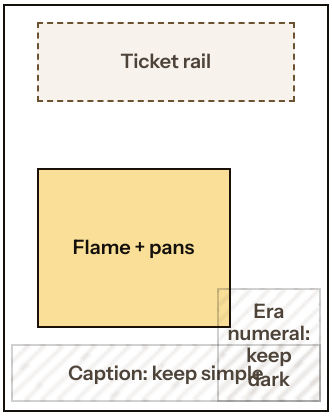
Hot orange flame light mixed with cool kitchen fluorescents.

AVOID

Restaurant names, health-code violations, cooks' faces (unless it's Chef Ray).

WHAT'S NEEDED

Access to a working restaurant kitchen during or staged as service.



Framing guide · 4:5 portrait · 2400 × 3000 px or larger

16

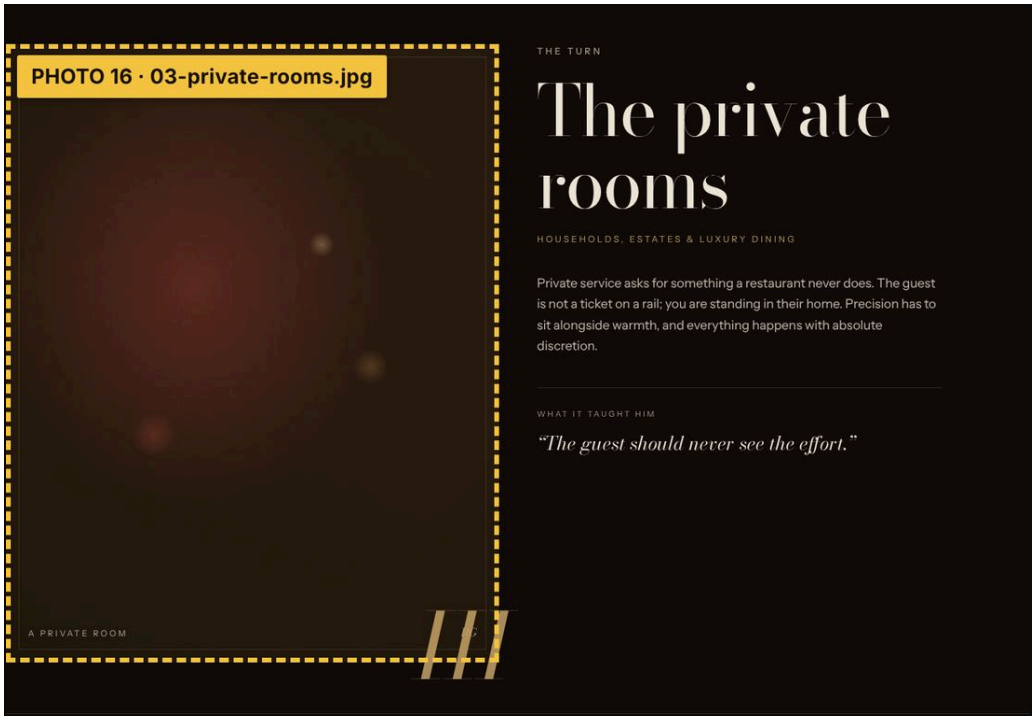
IMPORTANT

Caption on site: “A private room”

☐ Captured

III. The private rooms

`03-private-rooms.jpg`



On the website today. The yellow outline is the placeholder this photograph replaces.

Era III: private households, estates and luxury dining.

WHAT TO CAPTURE

A low-lit private dining room in a grand home: one round table for eight dressed and lit by candles, a slightly open service door spilling warm kitchen light across the floor.

IN THE FRAME

- Dark green silk or deep red lacquered walls; a large oil painting in a gilded frame, in shadow.
- Crystal chandelier dimmed low.
- Service door in the left third of the frame.
- No people.

LIGHT & COLOR

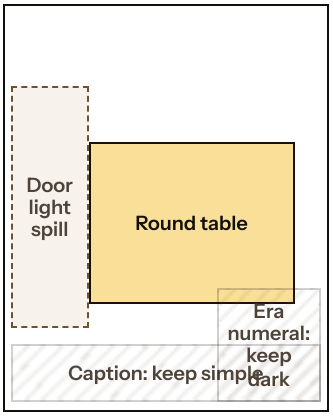
Candles plus the warm spill from the door.

AVOID

Identifiable artwork or homeowner details.

WHAT'S NEEDED

An elegant private dining room (estate, club or historic home).



Framing guide · 4:5 portrait · 2400 × 3000 px or larger

17

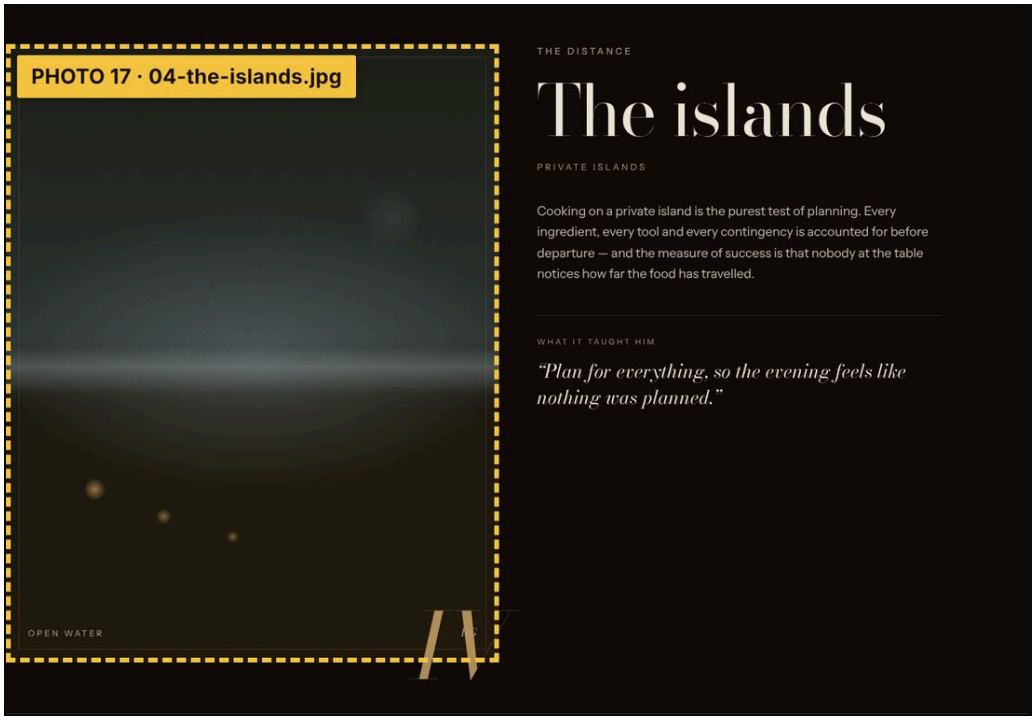
COMPLETES THE SET

Caption on site: “Open water”

☐ Captured

IV. The islands

`04-the-islands.jpg`



On the website today. The yellow outline is the placeholder this photograph replaces.

Era IV: private-island dining. Real history: use a real photo from his work if one exists.

WHAT TO CAPTURE

First choice: a real photograph from one of Chef Ray's island engagements, with any client details removed. Otherwise: a wooden dock on an island at dusk, lanterns lit, crates of provisions stacked at the near end.

IN THE FRAME

- Weathered dock leading to shore, lanterns on both sides.
- Wooden crates of lemons, herbs and bottles in the foreground.
- Calm blue-black water reflecting the lanterns.

LIGHT & COLOR

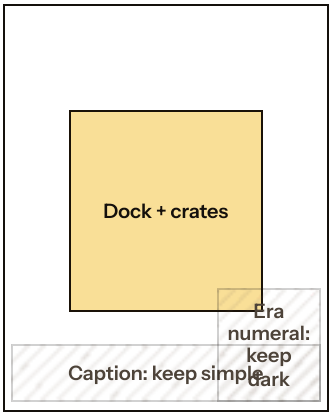
Dusk: violet sky, thin orange horizon.

AVOID

Anything identifying the client or island.

WHAT'S NEEDED

Chef Ray's own photos from past engagements, or the dock from Photo 06 (different angle).



Framing guide · 4:5 portrait · 2400 × 3000 px or larger

18

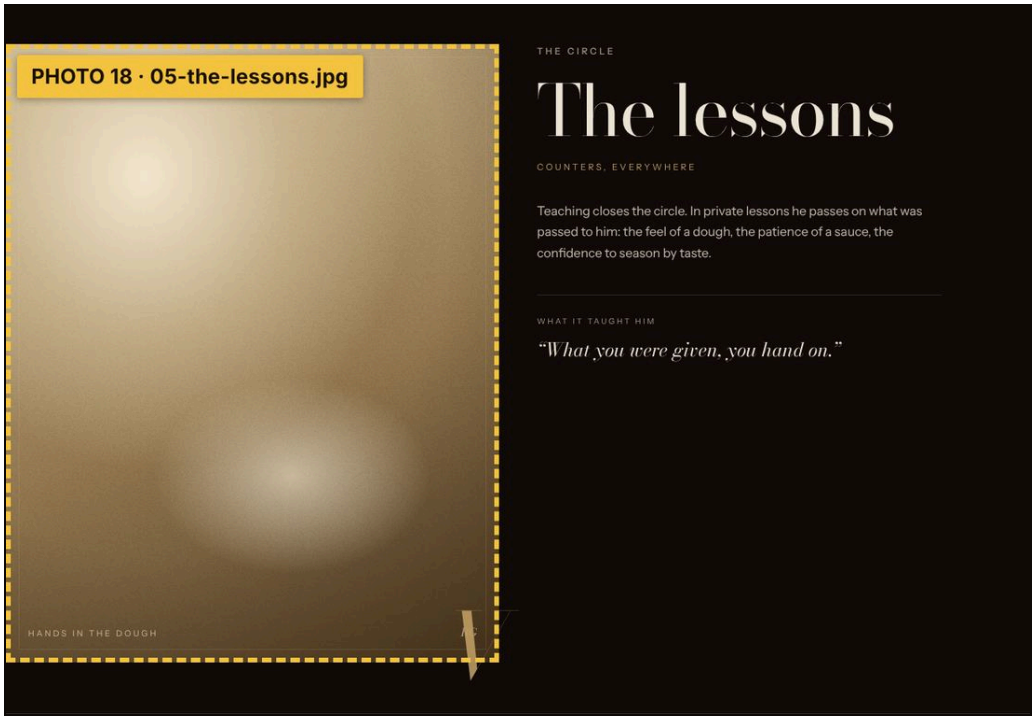
COMPLETES THE SET

Caption on site: “Hands in the dough”

☐ Captured

V. The lessons

`05-the-lessons.jpg`



On the website today. The yellow outline is the placeholder this photograph replaces.

Era V: teaching. Pairs with Photo 12 but is a different, closer moment.

WHAT TO CAPTURE

Very close on Chef Ray's flour-dusted hands placing a guest's fingers to show how to pinch and shape orecchiette pasta on a wooden board.

IN THE FRAME

- Only hands and forearms: his with rolled dark sleeves, the guest's in a cream knit sleeve.
- Rows of finished pasta, a bench scraper, a small bowl of semolina.
- Flour in the air.

LIGHT & COLOR

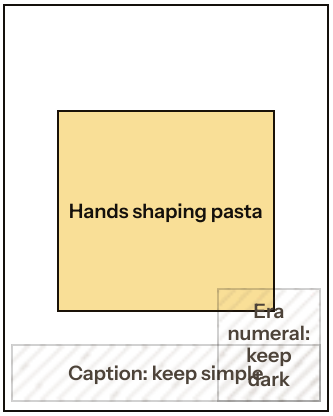
Window daylight from the side.

AVOID

Faces; making it look identical to Photo 12 (shoot closer, different shape of pasta).

WHAT'S NEEDED

Chef Ray plus one 'guest'. Same session as Photo 12.



Framing guide · 4:5 portrait · 2400 × 3000 px or larger

19

ESSENTIAL

Caption on site: “The table, tonight”

☐ Captured

VI. Wherever the table is

`06-now.jpg`



On the website today. The yellow outline is the placeholder this photograph replaces.

The final era: Chef Ray today. This closes his story, so it must be a real photo of him.

WHAT TO CAPTURE

Chef Ray at the head of a fully set, candlelit table in a client's dining room, minutes before guests arrive, making one last adjustment to a wine glass. He looks down at it; his face in three-quarter profile, lit by the candles.

IN THE FRAME

- Dark chef's jacket or dark tailored shirt.
- Long table glowing in ivory and brass, everything perfect.
- Room elegant and dim around him.

LIGHT & COLOR

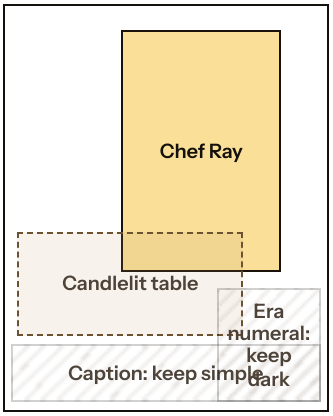
Candlelight on his face and hands; the room falls into shadow.

AVOID

Looking at the camera, guests in frame, flash.

WHAT'S NEEDED

Chef Ray. Can be shot in the same dining room as Photos 01 and 10.



Framing guide · 4:5 portrait · 2400 × 3000 px or larger

Shot checklist

#	PHOTOGRAPH	FILE NAME	PRIORITY	SHAPE	DONE
01	A home in Connecticut	`setting-residence.jpg`	Essential	16:11	☐
02	A Manhattan penthouse	`setting-penthouse.jpg`	Important	16:11	☐
03	A Hamptons estate	`setting-estate.jpg`	Completes the set	16:11	☐
04	A waterfront home in Florida	`setting-waterfront.jpg`	Completes the set	16:11	☐
05	Aboard a yacht	`setting-yacht.jpg`	Important	16:11	☐
06	On a private island	`setting-island.jpg`	Important	16:11	☐
07	In a private hangar	`setting-hangar.jpg`	Completes the set	16:11	☐
08	Somewhere abroad	`setting-abroad.jpg`	Completes the set	16:11	☐
09	Chef Ray in his kitchen	`chef-portrait.jpg`	Essential	4:5	☐
10	I. The Private Table	`private-table.jpg`	Essential	4:5	☐
11	II. The Island & The Water	`island-water.jpg`	Essential	4:5	☐
12	III. The Kitchen Lessons	`kitchen-lessons.jpg`	Essential	4:5	☐
13	IV. The Occasion	`occasion.jpg`	Essential	4:5	☐
14	I. The family table	`01-family-table.jpg`	Completes the set	4:5	☐
15	II. The line	`02-the-line.jpg`	Important	4:5	☐
16	III. The private rooms	`03-private-rooms.jpg`	Important	4:5	☐
17	IV. The islands	`04-the-islands.jpg`	Completes the set	4:5	☐
18	V. The lessons	`05-the-lessons.jpg`	Completes the set	4:5	☐
19	VI. Wherever the table is	`06-now.jpg`	Essential	4:5	☐

Chef Ray Gennaro · Photography guide for the website · Screenshots taken from the current build. A printable PDF of this guide is shared alongside it.